

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

I believe, when our earnings are tied directly to our output or performance.

Similarly, being underpaid in a role that we love, or give a lot of our time and energy to, or both, can start to seep into our sense of what we feel we're worth. Working yourself into the ground while simultaneously struggling to keep up with your outgoings is cruelly common in our stretched society, and especially in the public sector, where pay is dictated by central government as opposed to being related to performance or decided by your boss. A lack of pay mobility can make people feel undervalued and stuck. Let's not underestimate the toll that those feelings can have on your relationship with money either. When I was working sixty-hour weeks for a £16k salary after graduating from university, I developed an incredibly cavalier attitude towards my spending habits, and it landed me in a payday loan-shaped hole of trouble. I saw my hard work as a currency in itself, and I spent according to what I felt I deserved, rather than what I was actually earning. It's difficult, without a career change that often comes with its own financial impossibilities, to see how this can be overcome. The social-preneur (i.e those whose success is either driven by or displayed proudly on social media) discourse that we're used to seeing, particularly in some circles, can be scathing about the choice to stay in the 9–5 'trap', but a lot of people *like* their jobs and feel that they're making a difference, as well as benefitting from the security that employment lends you – they just want to be paid fairly for their time. What's important here, as well